THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Chapter 10: **Life on Earth** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** life	bio = life
2	**(b)** Amazon Basin	tropical rainforest
3	**(b)** desert	very little rainfall
4	**(d)** three-fourths	mostly oceans
5	**(a)** Western Ghats	unique species
6	**(b)** Thenmala	in Kollam district, Keralam
7	**(c)** Uttarakhand	village women hugged trees
8	**(a)** Joint Forest Management	JFM
9	**(a)** Bihar Fish Jalkar Management Act, 2006	commons-based model
10	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	roots cannot penetrate frozen soil

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A large natural region with similar climate, plants and animals (1); an ecosystem is a smaller community within a biome where living and non-living things interact (1).	1+1
12	Forest, grassland, desert and tundra (2).	2
13	They have the richest biodiversity (1) and preserve unique genetic material (1).	1+1
14	Savannas are tropical grasslands with scattered trees, as in Africa (1); prairies are temperate grasslands of North America used for farming (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Large natural region defined by similar climate, plants and animals (1); examples are tundra, desert and grassland (1); each supports different life forms (1).	1+1+1
16	Emergent layer of tallest trees (1); upper canopy and understory/lower canopy (1); forest floor that is damp and dark (1).	1+1+1
17	Large open areas with mostly grass and few trees in moderate-rainfall regions (1); temperate grasslands such as prairies and steppes are fertile and used for farming (1); tropical savannas support lions, elephants and giraffes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is one of the world's largest salt deserts in Gujarat (1); it becomes a marshy wetland in the monsoon (1); it turns into a vast white salt desert in the dry season (1).	1+1+1
18	Tundra has mosses, lichens and shrubs with permafrost (1.5); the Himalaya in the subtropics has conifers and a wider variety of species (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: They cover about three-fourths of the Earth and include freshwater and marine biomes (1); freshwater gives drinking water, irrigation and fish (1); marine biomes store heat, regulate climate and give food and livelihoods (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Large natural region with similar climate, plants and animals (1). (ii) Forest, grassland, desert and tundra with features (3). (iii) Differences in temperature and rainfall (1).	1+3+1
	OR: (i) Hot and wet region between 23.5° N and 23.5° S, with layers of vegetation (3). (ii) Rich biodiversity and genetic material (1). (iii) Andaman & Nicobar Islands or North-East India (1).	3+1+1
20	(i) Driest biome, hot like Sahara or cold like Gobi, with the Rann of Kutch as a salt desert (2). (ii) Cacti store water; camels and lizards withstand heat (2). (iii) Livestock rearing, minerals and oil, tourism (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Hot desert and cold desert (1). (ii) Temperature differs, so thick fur is needed against cold (1). (iii) Sandy with sparse vegetation (1). (iv) Minerals and oil (2).	1+1+1+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Chapter 10: **Life on Earth** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** an ecosystem is like a neighbourhood within a biome	biome is broader
2	**(b)** emergent layer	tallest trees stand above the canopy
3	**(d)** a vast salt desert that becomes marshy in the monsoon	in Gujarat
4	**(d)** River or lake	marine biomes are salty
5	**(d)** allow animals to move between habitats safely	reduce habitat fragmentation
6	**(c)** honey, fruits, nuts, resins and medicinal plants	NTFPs
7	**(a)** originating from a specific place with qualities linked to it	intellectual property right
8	**(a)** Gadchiroli, Maharashtra	Gond tribe
9	**(a)** eri	traditional water bodies
10	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	community protection

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	They store water and tolerate heat (1); cacti and camels (1).	1+1
12	Soil frozen almost throughout the year (1); in the tundra biome near the polar regions (1).	1+1
13	Freshwater: rivers or lakes (1); marine: oceans or coral reefs (1).	1+1
14	Producers like plants and algae (1) because they capture solar energy by photosynthesis (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The relationship among organisms in terms of energy, numbers or biomass (1); producers at the base followed by herbivores, carnivores and top consumers (1); energy declines upwards due to loss as heat (1).	1+1+1
16	Biomes give habitats to plants, animals and humans (1); animals help in pollination and seed dispersal, microorganisms recycle nutrients (1); humans modify landscapes for farming and cities (1).	1+1+1
17	Identifying hotspots like the Western Ghats (1); using protected areas such as national parks and biosphere reserves (1); planning wildlife corridors across rivers, mountains and valleys (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It supports conservation and local income with minimal harm (1); Thenmala is India's first planned ecotourism destination in Keralam (1); locals work as guides and eco-guards (1).	1+1+1
18	They get food, fuel, fodder, medicine, timber and bamboo (1); NTFPs like honey, nuts and resins give income (1); forests support grazing, crafts and cultural rituals (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They are protected by communities on religious grounds, with over 1,00,000 in India (1); they preserve rare and medicinal plants and wildlife (1); some maintain streams and groundwater (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Coldest biome with long winters, permafrost, mosses and lichens (2). (ii) Small changes in temperature disturb life (1). (iii) Himalaya has conifers and different species (2).	2+1+2
	OR: (i) Cover three-fourths of Earth; freshwater and marine biomes with examples (3). (ii) Drinking water, farming, fish, heat storage and climate regulation (2).	3+2
20	(i) Variety of life forms and habitats (1). (ii) Hotspots, ecosystem-based conservation, protected areas, corridors and human–environment interaction (3). (iii) Himalaya, Western Ghats, North-East India, Andaman & Nicobar Islands (1).	1+3+1

	OR: (i) Kollam district, Keralam (1). (ii) Tourism, Forest and Irrigation Departments (1). (iii) Honey Hill (1). (iv) Employed as guides, eco-guards and service providers, sharing the benefits (2).	1+1+1+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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